that is among the Shudras. This process of assimilation was a continuous one. These castes must have been in a fluid condition; rigidity came in much later. Probably the ruling class h a d always great latitude, and any person who by conquest or otherwise assumed power, could, if he so willed, join the hierarchy as a Kshatriya, and get the priests to manufacture an appropriate genealogy connecting him with some ancient Aryan hero.

T h e word *Arya* ceased to have any racial significance and came to m e a n 'noble', just as *unarya* meant ignoble and was usually applied to nomadic tribes, forest-dwellers, etc.

85

T h e Indian mind was extraordinarily* analytical and h a d a passion for putting ideas and concepts, and even life's activities, into compartments. The Aryans not only divided society into four main groups but also divided the individual's life into four parts: the first part consisted of growth and adolescence, the student period of life, acquiring knowledge, developing self-discipline and self-control, continence; the second was that of the householder and m a n of the world; the third was that of the elder statesman, who had attained a ccrtain poise and ob-